Acme Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

Employee Handbook and Company Policies

Version 2.1 - Effective 1 January 2026

This is a fictional document created for demonstration purposes. It describes the policies of Acme Technologies, a sample software company based in Ahmedabad, India.

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1. Working Hours and Attendance

The standard working week is Monday to Friday, 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, including a one-hour lunch break. Core collaboration hours are 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM, during which employees are expected to be available for meetings.

Employees arriving after 10:00 AM three times in a calendar month will receive a written reminder. A fourth late arrival is recorded as a half-day leave. Attendance is marked through the HR portal.

Overtime must be approved in advance by the reporting manager. Approved overtime is compensated with compensatory leave at a 1:1 ratio, to be taken within 60 days.

2. Leave Policy

Full-time employees receive the following annual leave entitlements:

Leave type	Days per year	Notes
Casual leave	12	Cannot be carried forward
Sick leave	10	Medical certificate needed for more than 2 consecutive days
Earned leave	18	Up to 30 days can be carried forward; encashable at exit
Maternity leave	26 weeks	As per the Maternity Benefit Act
Paternity leave	10 working days	To be used within 6 months of the child's birth

Leave requests of more than 3 days must be submitted at least 14 days in advance. Unplanned leave should be reported to the manager by 10:00 AM on the same day.

3. Remote Work Policy

Acme follows a hybrid model. Employees are expected to work from the office at least 3 days per week (Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday are the anchor days). Up to 2 days per week may be worked remotely without special approval.

Fully remote arrangements

Fully remote work requires written approval from the department head and HR. It is granted for a maximum of 30 days per year for reasons such as relocation, family emergencies or extended travel. Employees on a probation period (first 6 months) are not eligible for fully remote work.

Remote work equipment and allowance

Employees working remotely receive a monthly internet allowance of INR 1,000, payable with the salary. A one-time home-office setup allowance of INR 15,000 is available after completing probation, and can be claimed once every 3 years.

Availability while remote

Remote employees must be reachable on Slack during core hours, join scheduled video meetings with the camera on, and respond to urgent messages within 30 minutes.

4. Expense Reimbursement

Employees can claim reimbursement for business-related expenses incurred with prior approval from their manager. Claims must be submitted through the HR portal within 30 days of the expense, with original receipts attached. Claims submitted after 30 days will be rejected.

Spending limits

Category	Limit	Approval needed
Domestic travel - flights	Economy class only	Manager
Hotel (metro cities)	INR 6,000 per night	Manager
Hotel (other cities)	INR 4,000 per night	Manager
Daily meal allowance (travel)	INR 1,200 per day	None
Client entertainment	INR 5,000 per event	Department head
Learning and certifications	INR 25,000 per year	Manager + HR

Approved reimbursements are paid within 10 working days, in the next payroll cycle. Personal expenses, fines and alcohol are never reimbursable.

5. IT and Data Security

All employees must use the company-issued laptop for work. Personal devices may access company email only through the approved mobile app with a screen lock enabled.

Passwords and access

Passwords must be at least 12 characters long and changed every 90 days. Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for email, the code repository and the cloud console. Sharing passwords with anyone, including colleagues, is prohibited.

Handling confidential data

Customer data must never be copied to personal drives or sent to personal email. Files classified as Confidential must be stored only in the company cloud drive. Pasting customer data or source code into public AI tools is not allowed; only the company-approved AI assistant may be used.

Reporting incidents

Lost devices, suspected phishing or data leaks must be reported to security@acme-demo.example within 2 hours of discovery. Prompt reporting will not result in disciplinary action.

6. Code of Conduct and Grievances

Acme is committed to a respectful workplace. Harassment, discrimination, bullying and retaliation are not tolerated. Employees are expected to treat colleagues, clients and vendors with courtesy.

Conflict of interest

Employees must disclose outside employment or freelance work to HR. Freelance work is permitted only if it does not compete with Acme's business or use company time and resources.

Raising a grievance

Employees can raise a concern with their manager, with HR at hr@acme-demo.example, or anonymously through the ethics hotline. HR will acknowledge a complaint within 3 working days and aim to resolve it within 30 days. Complaints about workplace harassment are handled by the Internal Committee, with strict confidentiality.

Notice period and exit

The notice period is 60 days for confirmed employees and 30 days during probation. Final settlement, including leave encashment, is paid within 45 days of the last working day.

7. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How many days a week must I come to the office?
A: At least 3 days, including the anchor days Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday.

Q: Can I work from my hometown for a month?
A: Yes, with written approval from your department head and HR, for up to 30 days a year. This is not available during probation.

Q: When does the health insurance start?
A: Group health insurance of INR 5 lakh covers the employee, spouse and up to 2 children from the date of joining. Parents can be added at an extra premium.

Q: When is salary paid?
A: Salary is credited on the last working day of each month.

Q: What is the annual performance review cycle?
A: Reviews happen twice a year, in April and October. Increments take effect from 1 May.

Q: Is there a bonus?
A: A variable performance bonus of up to 10% of annual salary is paid in June, based on company and individual performance.